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Revision Date:
July 1, 2026

Background:
State Law requires counties to administer Refugee Supportive Services (RSS) in accordance with the County Refugee Supportive Services Plan. The Refugee Employment Services (RES) program, implemented by the County of San Diego, provides in-depth case management and supportive services to help newly arrived refugee families and longer-term refugees who have been in the county for less than five years, quickly achieve economic self-sufficiency through employment.

Purpose:
The purpose of this revision is to update the requirements for the Family Self-Sufficiency Plan (FSSP) and provide clarification on RES eligibility factors.

Policy:
CalWORKs recipients who meet RES eligibility criteria will be eligible to receive services to help obtain or retain employment. Participants who are not employment-ready will receive services through the CalWORKs Employment Services (ES) program.

RES Eligibility Criteria
To be eligible to receive RES, a participant must be:
- A qualifying non-citizen who has been granted one of the designated immigration statuses specified in the following section.
- Residing in the United States for 60 months or less.
- Sixteen years or older and not a full-time student in elementary or secondary school.
- Employed or 'Employment ready' and actively seeking employment.

RES Immigration Status and Eligibility Timeframes
Qualifying refugees can receive RES for up to 60 calendar months. The following table includes a list of RES immigration statues and how to determine the RES 60- month beginning date.

Immigration Status	RES 60-Month Beginning Date
Refugee, Special Immigrant Visa (SIV), Amerasians from Vietnam	Date of Entry (DOE)
Asylee	Asylum status grant date
Cuban and Haitian Entrants	Date parole or other status was granted
Human Trafficking and Crime Victims (refer to CalWORKs Program Guide 70-100.A)	• Trafficking Crime Victims Assistance Program (TCVAP) recipients: Application date • Non-TCVAP recipients: ○ Date of Office of Refugee Resettlement (ORR) Certification Letter for victims 18 years old and older ○ Date of ORR Eligibility Letter for victims under 18 years old

Additional immigration statuses eligible for RES:
Ukrainian and Non-Ukrainian Humanitarian Parolees paroled into the United States (U.S) between February 24, 2022 and September 30, 2023, are eligible until the end of their parole term. These individuals' spouses or unmarried children under the age of 21 who are paroled into the United States after September 30, 2023 are also eligible.

Afghan Humanitarian Parolees paroled into the U.S. between July 31, 2021, through September 30, 2023, are potentially eligible until March 31, 2023, or the end of their parole term, whichever is later. Spouses or children of these individuals paroled into the U.S. after September 30, 2023 are also eligible.

Verification of Immigration Status
Staff will verify and/or validate qualifying immigration status by viewing the United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) documentation. RES participants are not required to provide their Social Security number (SSN) to receive ES through the RES program.

Definition of Employment Ready
A participant will be considered employment ready, if they have skills that will lead to immediate gainful employment. For example, a participant who was a nurse in their home country has the skills and experience that will lead to gainful employment within one year.

Services Available through RES
Participants will be offered all services available to eliminate any barriers preventing them from gaining employment. Below are services available through RES:
- Development of a FSSP that establishes job-related experience and job retention services.
- Activities that provide acculturation and life skill experiences.
- In-depth case management, including employability assessment and translation services.
- Referrals for barrier removal services such as mental health and conflict resolution.
- English language training through a variety of avenues, such as Vocational English-as-Second Language (VESL) or local vocational training programs.
- On-the-job training.
- Monetary supportive services (CalWORKs recipients only).

FSSP
All RES participants will be required to complete the FSSP, in addition to an ES plan. The FSSP will assist the participant and staff to identify the services needed to address barriers and needs of the participant, as well as to establish income and resources necessary to achieve economic self-sufficiency. The FSSP must include each member of the family, including children. The FSSP will set measurable short- and long-term goals, steps, and strategies to obtain and retain employment based on the needs of the whole family.

The FSSP must include the following:
- A comprehensive assessment for each family member, including children.
- Strengths and assets.
- Stressors and barriers.

- A family budget, including itemized expenses and sources of income.
- An Individual Employability Plan (IEP).
- Short-term and long-term goals.
- Referrals to services.

A follow-up assessment must be completed at 6 and 12 months, which includes:
- An assessment of progress and outcomes.
- Documentation if the initial primary goal was met or not met.
- Identification of any new barriers.
- Offer of new referrals for resources.
- Employment status, if employed, the number of months employed part-time or full-time, as well as the hourly wage.
- A revised family budget.
- A revised IEP.

FSSP Exceptions
A FSSP is not required for participants enrolled only in English as a Second Language (ESL) classes for purposes other than obtaining or retaining employment. For example, participants who are already employed and enroll in ESL to improve their English.

Refugee Cash Assistance (RCA) and TCVAP Recipients
RCA and TCVAP recipients must participate in work-related activities unless exempt. Some TCVAP recipients may not possess a SSN or work authorization. As an alternative, job readiness, life skills, acculturation, and ESL activities may be assigned in preparation for future employment.

90-Day Retention
The 90-day retention period begins with the start date of the RES participant's first job. Follow-up is required to verify retention with RES participants 90 days from the start date of employment.

Procedure:
CalWORKs Processing Guide 10-200.A1

References:
- County Refugee Program Guidelines https://www.cdss.ca.gov/inforesources/refugees/guidance/state-and-fed-regs
- United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) Class of Admission Codes: https://sdcountycagov.sharepoint.com/sites/Eligibility/cfip/Desk_Aid_USCIS_Class_of_Admission_Codes_Table_(03-11).docx
- All County Letter (ACL) 22-102
- Policy Letter 21-06
- County Refugee Program Guideline CDSS

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by July 31, 2029

Approval for Release:



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